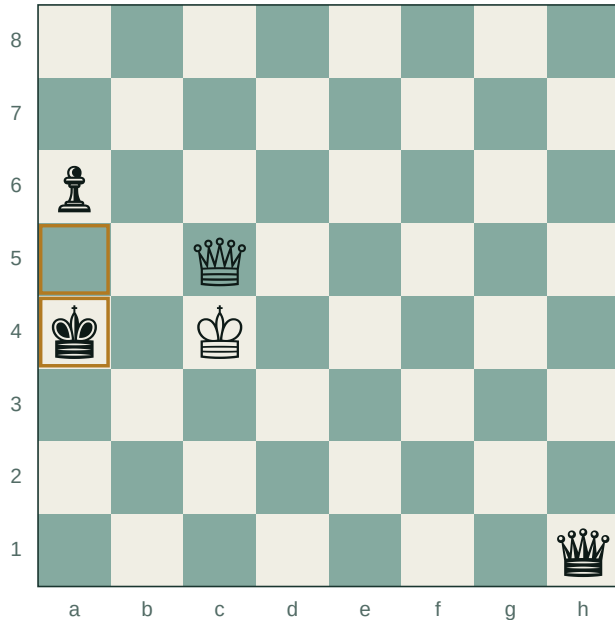


Queen-ending tactics: White, move 53

Queen-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 52...Ka4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

53. Qb4#

53.Qb4# Mate: queen on b4 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a4. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on b4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on a4. Geometrically undefended: queen on h1. Check for tactical protection.